

3.1 Literary genres

In Literary genres, the texts are connected through a mainstream literary genre: either Aspects of tragedy or Aspects of comedy. Tragedy and comedy have a long tradition in literature, with their origins in the ancient world and with a specific emphasis on drama. Texts have been selected and grouped together because they share some of the common features of traditional tragic and comic drama while also offering some interesting variations. We are, therefore, looking at an older historical form and measuring later texts and their approaches to tragedy or comedy against a literary genre which is long established.

Students will choose one of the following options:

- Option A: Aspects of tragedy
- Option B: Aspects of comedy

Students study **four** texts: **one** Shakespeare play, **one** further drama text, **one** poetry text and **one** prose text.